CODEALPHA CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP · TASK 2

Phishing Awareness Training

How to recognize, avoid and report phishing attacks

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AGENDA

What we'll cover

01
What phishing is
Definition, channels and the most common types

02
Phishing emails
Red flags and an annotated fake email

03
Fake websites
How to read a URL before you trust a page

04
Social engineering
The psychological tricks attackers rely on

05
Real-world cases
Famous attacks and everyday scam messages

06
Staying safe
Best practices, damage control and a quiz

01 · THE BASICS

What is phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack in which criminals pretend to be someone you trust (a bank, your boss, a delivery company) to trick you into giving away passwords, money or personal data.

Email

Fake messages from banks, services or colleagues

SMS · Smishing

Texts with links about prizes, parcels or blocked accounts

Calls · Vishing

Callers posing as bank staff or tech support

Social apps

Fake profiles and hacked friends on WhatsApp or Facebook

Common types of phishing

Type	How it works	Example
Spear phishing	Targeted, using your personal details	Email that names your real manager
Whaling	Spear phishing aimed at executives	Fake legal notice sent to a CEO
Clone phishing	Copy of a real email, link swapped	Re-sent “invoice” from a known supplier
Smishing	Phishing by SMS	“Parcel on hold, pay Rs. 150 to release”
Vishing	Phishing by phone call	“Bank” caller asking for your OTP
Quishing	Malicious QR codes	Fake QR sticker on a parking meter

02 · PHISHING EMAILS

8 red flags in a phishing email

Mismatched sender

The name says your bank, the address says otherwise.

Urgency & threats

“Act within 24 hours or your account will be closed.”

Generic greeting

“Dear Customer” instead of your real name.

Disguised links

Hover first: the real address differs from the text.

Odd attachments

Unexpected .zip, .exe or macro-enabled files.

Asks for secrets

Real banks never ask for your PIN, password or OTP.

Poor language

Spelling mistakes, odd phrasing, blurry logos.

Too good to be true

Prizes and refunds you never applied for.

Anatomy of a phishing email

1 **From:** SecureBank Support <alerts@securebank-verify.co>

2 **Subject:** URGENT: Your account will be suspended in 24 hours

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3 Dear Customer,

We detected unusual activity on your account. To avoid suspension, verify your details immediately.

4 **Verify My Account**

→ `http://securebank.account-check.xyz/login`

SecureBank Security Team

1. **Look-alike domain.** The real bank would use securebank.com.
2. **Fake urgency.** A deadline pushes you to act before thinking.
3. **Generic greeting.** They don't know your name.
4. **Dangerous button.** It leads to an unrelated domain, account-check.xyz.

03 · FAKE WEBSITES

Read the URL before you trust the page

`https://securebank.com.login-verify.net/account`

The real owner is the domain just before the first single "/". Here it is **login-verify.net**, not securebank.com.

Look-alike spelling

paypa1.com, amaz0n-support.com, faceb00k-login.net: one swapped letter is enough.

The padlock isn't proof

HTTPS only means the connection is encrypted. Scammers get free certificates too.

Go there yourself

Use a bookmark or type the address instead of clicking links in messages.

04 · SOCIAL ENGINEERING

Hacking people, not computers

Urgency

Pressure to act now, before you have time to think.

Authority

Posing as a boss, bank, police officer or IT support.

Fear

Threats of fines, arrest or a blocked account.

Greed & curiosity

Prizes, refunds, “see who viewed your profile”.

Trust

A hacked friend’s account asking for money or a code.

Pretexting

A believable story: “I’m from IT, I need your password to fix your email.”

05 · REAL-WORLD CASES

Big names have fallen for it too

2013 – 2015

Google & Facebook

A scammer posed as a real hardware supplier and emailed fake invoices. The two companies wired him over $100 million before the fraud was caught.

JULY 2020

Twitter

Attackers phoned employees pretending to be internal IT support, stole their logins and hijacked famous accounts to post a Bitcoin scam.

2016

US election campaign

A campaign chairman got a fake “someone has your password” Google alert. The fake link gave attackers access, and his emails were later leaked.

Lesson: phishing targets people, not technology. Anyone can be fooled when rushed.

05 · EVERYDAY SCAMS

Messages you might receive this week

PRIZE SCAM

"Congratulations! Your number won Rs. 50,000 in a lucky draw. Call now to claim it."

Red flag: you never entered any draw.

FAKE SUPPORT PAYMENT

"Your support payment is ready. Reply with your ID card number and the code we sent."

Red flag: officials never ask for codes by SMS.

PARCEL SCAM

"Your parcel is on hold. Pay the Rs. 150 redelivery fee here: bit.ly/..."

Red flag: a short link and an unexpected fee.

WHATSAPP TAKEOVER

"Hi! I sent you a 6-digit code by mistake. Can you forward it to me please?"

Red flag: that code is the key to your account.

06 · STAYING SAFE

Best practices to avoid phishing

Do

- Verify through the official app, website or phone number
- Hover over links to see the real address
- Turn on two-factor authentication (2FA)
- Keep your phone, browser and antivirus updated
- Use a password manager: it won’t fill passwords on fake sites
- Report suspicious messages to IT or your bank

⚠ Don’t

- Share passwords, PINs or OTP codes with anyone
- Open attachments you weren’t expecting
- Click links in urgent or threatening messages
- Scan QR codes from unknown sources
- Reuse the same password on different sites

06 · DAMAGE CONTROL

Clicked a phishing link? Act fast.

1

Disconnect

Turn off Wi-Fi or mobile data on the affected device.

2

Change passwords

From a safe device, starting with email and banking.

3

Call your bank

Block cards and accounts if you shared any details.

4

Scan the device

Run a full antivirus scan and remove unknown apps.

5

Report it

Tell your IT team, your bank and the cybercrime authorities.

Then turn on 2FA everywhere and watch your accounts for unusual activity.

QUICK CHECK

Phish or legit? Click to reveal

SMS

“Your bank account is blocked. Verify now at securebank-verify.top/login”

Phish

A threat plus a domain that isn’t the bank’s.

Email from your boss’s personal Gmail

“Urgently buy 5 gift cards and send me the codes. I’m stuck in a meeting.”

Phish

Classic CEO fraud. Call your boss to check.

Email, one minute after you clicked “Forgot password”

A reset link from the site’s real domain, for the account you just tried to log in to.

Legit

You started it and the domain matches. Never forward the link.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Stop. Think. Verify.

Pause before you click, check the sender and the link, and confirm through an official channel.

Take the full 10-question quiz:
[https://forms.gle/DUcge1BQsC7htqdWA]

Thank you! [Muhammad MAahad Asif] · CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship